WEEK 7 • TNF FILM AUDIT

PATRIOTS @ BEARS: THE 2 PREGAME ADJUSTMENTS

A schematic breakdown of the ground game and third downs behind Thursday night at Soldier Field.

ADJUSTMENT 01 • THE GROUND GAME

216

CHICAGO RUSH ATTEMPTS

Chicago has 964 rush yards at 4.5 a carry. New England allows 3.9.

- CHI RUSH TDS: 13 • NE ALLOWED: 5

ADJUSTMENT 02 • THIRD DOWN

25.8%

CHI D THIRD-DOWN RATE ALLOWED

New England converts 40.5% of third downs. Chicago allows 16 of 62.

- CHI OFFENSE CONVERTS 45.5% OF THIRD DOWNS

THE TACTICAL IMPERATIVE

Chicago wants to run. New England wants to stay on the field.

Two 4-2 teams, two clear levers: how Chicago's run-heavy offense meets a 3.9-a-carry defense, and who wins third down.

- 7-PAGE SLIDE DECK

DATA: PRO-FOOTBALL-REFERENCE, NFL.COM • THROUGH WEEK 6

THE GROUND GAME EDGE

THE GROUND GAME EDGE: CHICAGO VS. NE'S FRONT

Chicago leads the league in rush attempts and yards. New England allows 3.9 a carry.

YARDS PER CARRY: CHICAGO OFFENSE VS. NEW ENGLAND DEFENSE ALLOWED

BEARS RUSH OFFENSE, 2026 SEASON



216 CARRIES, 964 YARDS • PRO-FOOTBALL-REFERENCE

PATRIOTS RUSH DEFENSE, YARDS ALLOWED PER CARRY



140 CARRIES, 551 YARDS ALLOWED • PRO-FOOTBALL-REFERENCE

WHAT THE NUMBERS SAY

Chicago has 13 rushing TDs; New England has allowed 5

THE TREND

Chicago leads the NFL in rush attempts and yards, and has rushed for 13 touchdowns.

D'Andre Swift has 94 carries for 398 yards and 6 TDs.

THE COUNTERPOINT

Chicago rushed for 81 yards in Week 5 and 98 in Week 6.

Those are its two lowest totals of the season.

WATCH: CHICAGO NEEDS 3.9+ YARDS PER CARRY TO BEAT NEW ENGLAND'S ALLOWED RATE

THE OFFENSIVE MANDATE:

Keep the run in the script. Chicago's 291 rush yards in Week 1 show the ceiling.

Run volume keeps the Chicago offense in manageable down and distance.

DATA: PRO-FOOTBALL-REFERENCE, NFL.COM • THROUGH WEEK 6

THE TACTICAL BLUEPRINT

THE BLUEPRINT:
RUN TO CONTROL THE CLOCK

How Chicago turns volume on the ground into field position and time of possession.

STEP 1 • FRONT-LOAD THE RUN

Swift carries the early-down load

Swift has 94 carries and 6 rushing TDs through six games. That workload is the baseline.

STEP 2 • WIN THE DRIVE BATTLE

Chicago averages 6.62 plays a drive

Chicago's offense averages 3:11 per drive, second in the NFL. New England's offense averages 2:59.

STEP 3 • FINISH IN THE RED ZONE

Touchdowns, not field goals

Chicago scores TDs on 13 of 26 red-zone trips (50.0%). New England's defense allows 9 of 18 (50.0%).

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE PLAN

964

CHI RUSH YARDS

Most in the NFL after Week 6

3:11

CHI TIME PER DRIVE

Offense average, 2nd in NFL

50.0%

CHI RED ZONE TD RATE

13 TDs on 26 trips

LIVE IN-GAME TRIGGER: TRACK CHICAGO'S FIRST-DOWN CALLS, RUN OR PASS?

DATA: PRO-FOOTBALL-REFERENCE, NFL.COM • THROUGH WEEK 6

THE THIRD-DOWN BATTLE

THIRD DOWN:
WHO STAYS ON THE FIELD

Chicago converts 45.5% of its third downs. New England's defense allows 37.1%.

THIRD-DOWN CONVERSION RATE THROUGH WEEK 6

CHICAGO OFFENSE



40 OF 88 • PRO-FOOTBALL-REFERENCE

NEW ENGLAND DEFENSE, RATE ALLOWED



26 OF 70 ALLOWED • PRO-FOOTBALL-REFERENCE

THE OTHER SIDE OF THE BALL

Chicago's defense is second in the NFL on third down

CHICAGO'S DEFENSE

Chicago allows 25.8% on third down: 16 of 62.

That ranks 2nd in the NFL per Pro-Football-Reference.

NEW ENGLAND'S OFFENSE

New England converts 40.5% of third downs: 32 of 79.

That ranks 13th in the NFL. The Patriots are 8 of 10 on fourth down.

WATCH: NEW ENGLAND NEEDS TO BEAT 25.8% ON THIRD DOWN, CHICAGO'S ALLOWED RATE

THE SITUATIONAL MANDATE:

Stay ahead of the chains. New England has 13 giveaways, Chicago has 11.

Short third downs are the lever for both offenses.

DATA: PRO-FOOTBALL-REFERENCE, NFL.COM • THROUGH WEEK 6

THE THIRD-DOWN BLUEPRINT

THE BLUEPRINT: WIN THE SITUATIONS

Three things to watch as both offenses try to stay on schedule.

STEP 1 • CHECK THE OFFICIAL REPORTS

Quarterback and line statuses decide it

Caleb Williams (hamstring) was listed Questionable on the Week 6 report. Check the official Wednesday and Thursday reports.

STEP 2 • PROTECT THE QUARTERBACK

Sacks turn third-and-medium into long

Chicago's offense has allowed 15 sacks (6.73%). Drake Maye has been sacked 11 times (5.67%).

STEP 3 • KEEP THE BALL

Takeaways swing the field

Chicago's defense has forced 9 turnovers; New England's defense has forced 7.

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE PLAN

15

CHI SACKS ALLOWED

6.73% sack rate, Pro-Football-Reference

11

MAYE SACKS TAKEN

5.67% sack rate

9 / 7

CHI / NE TAKEAWAYS

Turnovers forced by each defense

LIVE IN-GAME TRIGGER: TRACK THIRD-DOWN DISTANCES, SHORT OR LONG?

DATA: PRO-FOOTBALL-REFERENCE, NFL.COM • THROUGH WEEK 6

THE VALIDATION SCORECARD

HOW TO SCORE THIS REPORT LIVE ON TNF

Track these 3 benchmarks during the broadcast to see who is winning the situations.

METRIC 01 • THE GROUND GAME

Yards per carry vs. season allowed rate

Benchmarks: CHI 3.9 or better (NE allows 3.9); NE 4.5 or better (CHI allows 4.5).

IF IT HOLDS: THE RUN GAME BEATS THE FRONT

METRIC 02 • THIRD DOWN

Third-down conversions

Benchmark: 5-for-12 (42%) or better. Season rates: CHI 45.5%, NE 40.5%.

IF IT HOLDS: DRIVES ARE STAYING ALIVE

METRIC 03 • BALL SECURITY

Giveaways by each offense

Benchmark: fewer than 2 per team. Season average: NE 2.2, CHI 1.8 per game.

IF IT HOLDS: THE OFFENSE PROTECTS THE BALL

SAVE THIS CAROUSEL FOR KICKOFF

Track these 3 benchmarks during the Prime Video broadcast.

We will post our halftime read on X and LinkedIn.

DATA: PRO-FOOTBALL-REFERENCE, NFL.COM • THROUGH WEEK 6

SLAM SPORTS AI

AI-POWERED SPORTS INTELLIGENCE

REAL SCHEME. REAL DATA. ZERO HOT TAKES.

We replace narrative noise with schematic charting and film verification.

PILLAR 01

LIVE TACTICAL CHARTING

Real-time tracking of box counts, coverage shells, and pressure rates.

PILLAR 02

SECOND-HALF ADJUSTMENTS

Coordinator adjustments modeled during the halftime window.

PILLAR 03

ACCOUNTABLE FILM AUDITS

Every pregame projection is checked against the game film afterward.

JOIN THE DISCUSSION

Who wins Thursday night: Chicago's ground game or New England's third-down offense?

Drop your score prediction and tell us which adjustment decides the game.

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